

2.4 Unit B604: Ethics 2 (Peace and Justice, Equality and Media)

Each of the faiths studied will be examined according to the issues specified below. Candidates should be able to support their answers with reference to the teachings, sacred texts, beliefs and attitudes of the faiths where appropriate. Candidates should also explore the significance and impact of religions.

In this unit candidates should reflect on the idea that religions have different approaches and attitudes and that there is diversity within each faith, its understanding of texts and its philosophy.

They should consider these issues in relation to the particular religion itself and to its impact on individuals, communities and societies, locally, nationally and globally whilst realising that these particular aspects may vary in significance between religions and communities.

They should also consider the extent to which the particular religion and belief being studied contributes to community cohesion.

Although the large variety of different philosophical and ethical views are not specified for each unit and whereas it would be too demanding for candidates to study a wide-range of different views at this level, nevertheless they should be aware that there is diversity of belief and opinion within each faith.

The final part of each question gives candidates the opportunity to express not only their personal views but also their understanding of other religions and beliefs including Humanism, Bahai, Jain and Zoroastrianism.

2.4.1 Buddhism

Religion, peace and justice

Attitudes to war	• Attitudes towards war • The concept of ahimsa
Violence and pacifism	• Attitudes towards the use of violence • Attitudes towards pacifism • Reasons for these attitudes
Crime and punishment	• Concept of justice • Aims of punishment • Attitudes towards capital punishment • Beliefs about the treatment of criminals • Responses to the treatment of criminals
Social injustice	• Concept of social justice and injustice • Beliefs about social injustice • Responses to social injustice

Religion and equality

Principle of equality	• Buddhist teachings about equality, including the rejection of the caste system
Attitudes towards racism	• Different views about prejudice and equality in relation to race • Practices in relation to racism

Attitudes towards gender	• Different views about prejudice and equality in relation to gender • The role of women in Buddhist society
Attitudes to religion	• Attitudes towards other religions with reference to: - Conversion to Buddhism - The attitude of Asoka to non-Buddhists - The status of non-Buddhist religions
Forgiveness and reconciliation	• Beliefs about forgiveness • Impact of beliefs about forgiveness on believers • Beliefs about reconciliation • Impact of beliefs about reconciliation on believers

Religion and the media

Relationship with the media	• The different forms of media • The influence of the media • Portrayal of Buddhism in the media • Portrayal of important religious figures • Responses and attitudes towards films which focus on religious/philosophical messages • Responses and attitudes towards books and comics which focus on religious/philosophical messages
Use of the media	• Using the media to represent Buddhism • To educate both Buddhists and non-Buddhists
Censorship/freedom of speech	• Concept of censorship and freedom of speech • Beliefs and attitudes towards the portrayal of violence and sex • Attitudes and responses to issues raised by freedom of speech